

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: I am losing my patience!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about domestic activities.
- I can write about solving problems.
- I can explain how to do things in a written way.

Ask your partner:

- Do the people in your family share the housework? Who does the most?
- What is your least favorite chore to do? Why?





Let's Explore!

Do you have some advice for women dealing with a "**lazybones**"?

* "*Lazybones*" is slang for a lazy person.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Sally,

I really need some advice. My husband and I were recently married. I have come to realize that he is oblivious to the amount of housework needed to maintain a home. I have a feeling that he would get his mother to cook, clean and wash for him. I'm sure he never lifted a finger. He was supposed to take out the trash this morning for collection but instead he slept in.

Last weekend, a group of his friends came over for pizza and to watch the hockey game. He promised me that he was going to clean up the "man cave" the next morning. Needless to say, I spent almost an hour vacuuming the carpet, collecting bottles and trying to get the stains out of the lounge suite. He was nowhere to be seen. I thought marriage was supposed to be an equal partnership. Right now, I'm getting the raw end of the deal.

Bitter and Confused

Dear Bitter and Confused,

I'm sorry to hear that your husband isn't pulling his weight around the house. My advice would be to sit down and have a frank discussion about your concerns. He needs to realize that he has responsibilities. Make a list of all the weekly household chores you complete and then get him to read it. Have him choose three chores to do for the week to start with.

Once, a friend of mine had her husband look after their house for two weeks while she went on holidays. He quickly understood the error of his ways. If the two of you are going to have a successful marriage, you need to be on the same page.

Sally



**Let's Practice!**

Husbands are supposed to ...

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Select all the incorrect words in the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. He was supposed to took out the trash this morning for collection but instead he slept in.

2. He promised me that he was go to clean up the "man cave" the next morning.

3. I thought marriage was suppose to be an equal partnership.

4. Sally told her that her husband were supposed to make things easier by pulling his own weight around the house.

5. She seemed very upset like she was going to got a divorce.

**Let's Practice!**

Get everyone on the same page ...

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Work Bank

- Get him to do
- Have his friends
- had her husband
- get him to read
- Have him choose

1. Make a list of all the weekly household chores you complete and then _____ it.
2. _____ three chores to do for the week to start with.
3. Once, a friend of mine _____ look after their house for two weeks while she went on holidays.
4. _____ also talk to him about doing chores in the house.
5. _____ the chores that you have problems doing.



Extension Activity

Write a letter asking for advice.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read the text again.
- Imagine that you have been married a short time and now are finding problems with the division of household chores.
- Write to an advice columnist asking for help.
- Write back from the columnist giving ideas to solve the problem.
- Read your letters to a partner and check together for grammar and spelling mistakes.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I use the causative with 'have' and write about problems and solving problems.

☐ ☐

I use 'be supposed to', 'was/were supposed to', and 'was/were going to' to explain how to do things.

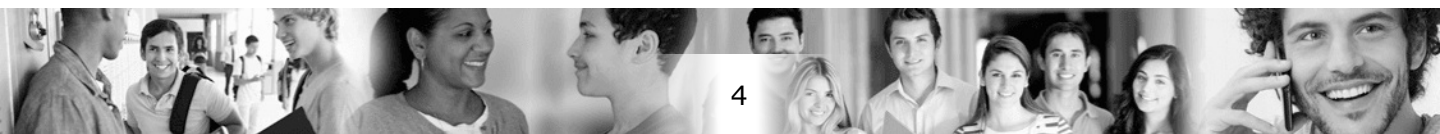
☐ ☐

I share my writing with a partner and check with him or her for spelling and grammar mistakes.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- oblivious** (adjective): unmindful; unaware of situations and surroundings
e.g. I have come to realize that he is oblivious to the amount of housework needed to maintain a home.
- to maintain** (verb): to keep in an appropriate condition; to keep it the way it is
e.g. I have come to realize that he is oblivious to the amount of housework needed to maintain a home.
- man cave** (expression): a room or other area in a home that is designed to accommodate the man's hobbies
e.g. He promised me that he was going to clean up the "man cave" the next morning.
- raw end of the deal** (expression): when something isn't fair or not in your favor
e.g. I thought marriage was supposed to be an equal partnership. Right now, I'm getting the raw end of the deal.
- pulling one's weight** (expression): doing your share in a common task
e.g. I'm sorry to hear that your husband isn't pulling his weight around the house.
- frank** (adjective): direct and straightforward; sincere
e.g. My advice would be to sit down and have a frank discussion about your concerns.
- on the same page** (expression): have the same understanding
e.g. If the two of you are going to have a successful marriage, you need to be on the same page.





Learning Points

Causative *Get* and *Have*

You use a causative verb when you want to talk about something that someone else did for you or for another person.

The subject caused the action to happen, but didn't do it themselves.

To have someone do something

You use the form:

Subject + *have* + person + infinitive

Here are some examples:

I had my husband make a list of all the things that needed to be fixed around the house.

The women had her daughter wash the dishes and sweep the floor.

To get someone to do something

You use the form:

get + someone + *to* + infinitive

Here are some examples:

The parents get their children to complete a list of chores before they are allowed to watch television.

I get my neighbor to help me clean the driveway.

Examples:

- *Once, a friend of mine had her husband look after their house for two weeks while she went on holidays.*
- *Have him choose three chores to do for the week to start with.*
- *Make a list of all the weekly household chores you complete and then get him to read it.*





Learning Points

Be Supposed To

You use the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements.

You can use *be supposed to* to talk about situations in the past, present or future.

The structure is:

Subject + to be + *supposed to* + verb

Present: *I am supposed to clean the house today.*

Past: *I was supposed to take out the trash last night.*

Future: *I am supposed to collect my dry cleaning tomorrow.*

****Pronunciation tip**:**

When you say *be supposed to*, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this:

Be suppose_to

Was/were going to

You use the future in the past to express the idea that in the past you thought something would happen in the future. It does not matter if you are correct or not.

Example:

We were going to take an equal share in the household chores.

Examples:

- *He was supposed to take out the trash this morning for collection but instead he slept in.*
- *He promised me that he was going to clean up the "man cave" the next morning.*
- *If the two of you are going to have a successful marriage, you need to be on the same page.*

